

SkyWater receives US\$ 15 million from the DOD

As part of the previously announced US\$ 27 million commitment, SkyWater Technology has announced that it has received US\$ 15 million from the US Department of Defense (DOD) to support open source design for its 90nm process offering. Through its dedication to open source silicon, SkyWater has teamed up with Google through the Google Public Sector and corporate engineering teams to support this endeavour. The open source SKY130 PDK, developed by SkyWater in conjunction with Google, enables open source design of unique application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs) using its 130nm mixed-signal CMOS technology.



The 90nm fully depleted silicon on insulator (FDSOI) CMOS process technology developed by MIT Lincoln Laboratory serves as the foundation for

SkyWater's new commercial SKY90-FD open source product. The most recent government-funded effort at SkyWater focuses on innovation, made possible by open source design, on the commercial application of this technology.

The DOD makes extensive use of open source software tools, which are becoming increasingly important in mission-critical defence applications and systems that must operate consistently and dependably. Open source fosters trust because of its transparency, which makes it easier to identify design flaws and dangerous code—something that is not always achievable with proprietary software—and accelerates innovation through cumulative efforts. This usage of open source has significantly advanced technology and raised the bar for American military.

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November 2022	Open Source and IoT and Edge
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